



Inspection Report

Noahs Ark Animal Rehab Center and Sanctuary Inc
712 L G Griffin Road
Locust Grove, GA 30248

Customer ID: **3157**

Certificate: **57-C-0037**

Site: 001

Noahs Ark Rehabilitation Center

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION

Date: 25-MAR-2026

3.150(a)

Repeat

Facilities, general.

Multiple avian enclosures require modification to adequately prevent injury to the birds.

- Aviary 11- Housing 2 Mexican red front parrots, 2 yellow headed amazons, and 1 Goffin cockatoo has exposed electrical wires in the holding area of this enclosure that the birds have access to. The electrical wires are located on the sides of the enclosure and are powering the heat emitters.

- Aviary 10- Housing 2 ringneck parrots, 2 green cheek conures, 3 nanday conures, 1 red bellied parrot, 1 cherry headed parrot, and 3 blue-crowned conures has an exposed heater that the birds could perch on and cause serious injury. A radiator heater placed on the floor of the enclosure has an exposed electrical power cord. A tarp that is being used to divide the enclosure has areas of disrepair and poses an entrapment risk to the birds in the enclosure.

- Aviary 9- Housing 10 cockatiels have one large heater and two small heaters affixed to the inside of the enclosure walls that creates a burn hazard. The electrical cords of these heaters are exposed to the birds. There is also an electric heater on the ground of this enclosure with an exposed electrical cord that the birds have access to. A tarp that is being used to divide the enclosure has areas of disrepair and poses an entrapment risk to the birds in the enclosure. During the inspection facility representatives and inspectors were unable to locate one of the cockatiels. Upon moving the tarp around and further inspection the bird was found to be nesting under a folded flap in the tarp along the floor.

- An enclosure housing 6 blue and yellow macaws, 1 scarlet macaw, 5 military macaws, 4 hybrid macaws, and 1 green wing macaw has plastic sheeting and tarp being utilized as a divider. The plastic sheeting and tarp were in disrepair most notably in the top right corner of the divider wall.

Failure to restrict access from electrical cords can lead to entrapment, injury, or death. Heating elements must be enclosed to ensure that the birds cannot gain access to areas that could injure or burn them if landed on. Tarps and other plastic materials pose a risk of entrapment to the birds and can lead to health issues if ingested. Housing facilities for birds must be designed and constructed so that they are structurally sound for the species of bird housed in them. They must be kept in good repair, protect the birds from injury, and restrict other animals from entering that may negatively affect the welfare of the birds within.

2.40(b)(2)

Critical

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

Prepared By: STEPHANIE MAYARD

USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Date:

03-APR-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative

Date:

03-APR-2026



Inspection Report

On 01/23/2026, a brown lemur was found lying on his side, curled in a ball, on the bottom of his outdoor enclosure. Per a facility representative, when found the lemur was barely conscious with eyes open but unresponsive and cold to the touch. The facility brought him inside to warm up but did not consult with a veterinarian for a treatment plan. The facility tried but was not able to get into contact with the attending veterinarian and did not seek guidance from an emergency backup veterinarian while caring for this lemur from the time he was found at 8:30 AM and the time he died at 12:30 PM. Per the records, the lemur became more alert shortly before dying around 11 AM and ate a few pieces of fruit which, per a facility representative, is the reason why they stopped pursuing medical consultation. Without veterinarian oversight, even during the brief moment of perceived improvement, the diagnosis as well as the methods used to care for this lemur might have been inadequate in restoring him back to health. The licensee, in conjunction with a veterinarian, must use appropriate methods to prevent, control, diagnose, and treat diseases and injuries, and must determine the availability of emergency, weekend, and holiday care. Correct by 04/08/2026.

2.40(b)(3)

Repeat

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

During inspection, the following three animals were identified with conditions requiring veterinary consultation:

- An adult black bear (Claire bear) was observed by inspectors with significant hair loss on the right shoulder blade and near the base of the neck. The right shoulder had approximately 5-inch by 5-inch patch of hair loss. The base of the neck primarily on the left side of the bear had an approximately 2-inch by 6-inch patch of hair loss.
- A brown-colored adult female goat (Millie) had abnormal hind feet. The toes were pointed inward with slight stacking on the tips of both hind feet. The gait of this animal was slightly abnormal, appearing stiff.
- A cream-colored male goat (Little D) had overgrown hoofs on both front feet. The hooves were excessively long and were curling inward. The hoof claws were grown approximately one inch from the wall of the hoof on the toes. Additionally, the soles were uneven, growing over one another, and interlocking.

The facility had not identified the conditions affecting these three animals, therefore had not contacted the veterinarian for guidance on care. Failure to promptly identify injuries delays treatment and may cause undue pain and distress in animals with such conditions. Correct by ensuring that the animals listed above, and the condition of those animals are reported to the attending veterinarian so that the animals can be properly examined, diagnosed, and treated. Additionally, ensure that daily observation of animals is adequate to identify any signs of poor health. Ensure that there is accurate and timely communication of problems of animal health, behavior, and well-being to the attending veterinarian.

2.131(d)(2)

Handling of animals.

The facility did not have readily identifiable employees or attendants present during periods of public contact. APHIS officials observed public contact between members of the public and multiple goats without a readily identifiable attendant in the immediate area managing these interactions. These interactions were observed by inspectors on both days of the inspection. Failure to have a knowledgeable and readily identifiable employee present during public contact creates a risk to both the animals and the public. The licensee must ensure that a responsible, knowledgeable, and readily identifiable employee is present at all times during periods of public contact. Correct by 04/10/2026.

2.131(e)

Critical

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Handling of animals.

Per the disposition records, 5 cockatiels and 1 ringneck parrot died in their outdoor enclosure during the winter season, mainly during the month of January. Specifically, the ringneck was found dead in aviary 10 on 01/30/2026, while the dates for the cockatiel deaths in aviary 9 were 01/05/2026, 01/19/2026, 01/25/2026, 01/29/2026, 02/02/2026. Senior staff at the facility verbally conveyed to both inspectors that they attributed these animal deaths to the cold temperatures in the area and the inability to maintain temperatures in the animal enclosures. Additionally, the "end-of-life records" noted that the circumstances leading to the death for the Ringneck parrot were "in the past 2 weeks, extreme winter weather and temps below freezing" and "extremely cold nights preceding event" for the cockatiel that died on 01/25/2026. The facility's temperature logs for the winter months (December to February) does indicate that in aviary 10, 53% of the temperature highs and 75% of the temperature lows were in the cold zone of 40 F to 53 F with two days having highs in the 30s. While in aviary 9, 21% of the temperature highs and 81% of the temperature lows were in the cold zone of 40F to 53 F with 6 days having lows in the 30s. According to local weather reports temperatures ranged from 26 F to 50 F on the above listed days.

Similarly, on 01/23/2026, an elderly brown lemur (20 years old) was found curled in a ball, lying on his side on the floor of his outdoor enclosure. The lemur died 4 hours later following care provided by facility representatives. Local weather reports indicate that the low was 44 F and the high was 48 F on 01/23/2026. Per a facility representative the lemur was cold to the touch when found and the "end-of-life records" note that "hypothermia seemed the likely cause". The lemur was pair housed and although they were both given access to a heated shelter, he did not use it and was found in the outdoor non-heated enclosure. It is unclear what medical or social impairment prevented this animal from utilizing the heated shelter however the access given to the non-heated outdoor enclosure was not adequate to maintain his well-being.

Failure to ensure that the climatic conditions are appropriate for the animals age, species, overall health status, and acclimation can result in stress and adverse health effects, including death. The natural environmental conditions for the species should be considered when developing the captive housing environment. Ringneck parrots are native to South Asia/Africa, Cockatiels to Australia, and Brown Lemurs from Madagascar (warm weather native species). Captive environments should reflect these conditions and avoid temperatures that adversely affect the animals.

When climatic conditions present a threat to an animal's health or well-being, appropriate measures must be taken to alleviate the impact of those conditions. An animal may never be subjected to any combination of temperature, humidity, and time that is detrimental to the animal's health or well-being, taking into consideration such factors as the animal's age, species, breed, overall health status, and acclimation. Correct by 04/06/2026.

3.125(a)

Repeat

Facilities, general.

At the time of inspection, the newest black bear named Claire Bear was completely hidden in a large hole she dug in her catch pen area. The hole was 22 inches deep and more than 92 inches long (how far inspector could get with measuring tape) tunneling below the fence of the catch pen towards the enclosure. This hole weakens the strength of the flooring in that section which could result in collapse while the bear is within or walking above the tunnel. This may in turn cause injury to the animal.

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The electrical wire at the level of the door adjacent to the catch pen is about 3 feet above the ground and there is a clearance between the bottom of that door and the floor. The facility is also not sure if this enclosure has a dig barrier and there are no electrical cords on the fence in the catch pen. Without adequate security measures to prevent Claire bear from digging under the primary enclosure fence there is also a risk of escape.

The outdoor housing facilities must be structurally sound and maintained in good repair to protect the animals from injury and to contain the animals.

3.150(c)(2)

Repeat

Facilities, general.

In the cockatiel aviary 9, two areas of significant rust were seen on two different horizontal metal poles that were part of the enclosure frame. The rusted section on both poles spanned an approximately 1 foot long area and was flaking at some places. The pole closest to the waterer had an approximately 1 inch wide by 0.5 inch long hole with irregular margins while the pole closest to the generator had a small cluster of about 6 holes with the biggest one being about 1 inch long also with irregular and sharp margins. Metal sheets were placed over these rusted sections but were not secured and at the time of inspection one was on the floor while the other was displaced exposing the rusted holed sections. These rusted areas prevent appropriate cleaning and sanitization and may lead to further structural integrity issues. The animals may also injure themselves on jagged surfaces resulting from disintegrating metal. Interior surfaces and surfaces that come in contact with birds must be free of rust or damage that affects the structural integrity of the surface or prevents cleaning.

3.150(c)(3)

Facilities, general.

Sharp points within animal reach could be found inside the four different aviaries:

- In aviary 11, all along the vertical part of the door frame that held the latch, there were several approximately half an inch long thin metal pieces (continuation of the metal wire that made the enclosure) projecting towards the door. On the top of this same enclosure, there were at least 4 screws with a sharp tip about half an inch long protruding down into the enclosure from an horizontal metal pole.
- In aviary 10, the thin small gauged chicken wire wrapped around the space heater on the floor was peeling away at one corner creating an exposed sharp edge.
- In aviary 9, there was an approximately 2.5 inches long and 2 inches wide damaged rectangular section of the enclosure fence below the black electrical cord with an orange tag. The metal was cut in the damaged section leaving behind small thin exposed metal pieces that bent into the enclosure. The facility wrapped and tied a piece of wire over the gap with the exposed ends also creating coiled pieces of sharp points protruding into the enclosure. In the same aviary, the metal mesh used to cover the ceiling heater, was damaged at one corner with a piece of thin sharp metal curled downwards into the enclosure.
- In the macaw aviary, in the triangular section above the fan box at the entrance, there was a vertical line with several half an inch long thin sharp metal pieces bent inwards towards the enclosure.

Sharp points such as these may cause injury to the birds housed within these aviaries. Interior surfaces and surfaces that come in contact with birds must be free of jagged edges or sharp points that could injure the birds. Correct by 04/15/2026.

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This inspection and exit interview were conducted with facility representatives.

Additional Inspectors:

Mark Sanderbeck, ANIMAL CARE INSPECTOR

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
3157	57-C-0037	001	Noahs Ark Rehabilitation Center	25-MAR-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000006	<i>Capra hircus</i>	DOMESTIC GOAT
000001	<i>Ovis aries aries</i>	SHEEP INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS
000002	<i>Amazona viridigenalis</i>	RED-CROWNED PARROT / GREEN-CHEEKED AMAZON / RED-CROWNED AMAZON / MEXICAN RED-HEA
000003	<i>Amazona oratrix</i>	YELLOW-HEADED PARROT / YELLOW-HEADED AMAZON / DOUBLE YELLOW-HEADED AMAZON
000001	<i>Cacatua goffiniana</i>	TANIMBAR CORELLA / GOFFIN'S COCKATOO
000002	<i>Psittacula krameri</i>	ROSE-RINGED PARAKEET
000002	<i>Pyrrhura molinae</i>	GREEN-CHEEKED PARAKEET / GREEN-CHEEKED CONURE
000003	<i>Aratinga nenday</i>	NANDAY PARAKEET / NANDAY CONURE
000001	<i>Poicephalus rufiventris</i>	RED-BELLIED PARROT
000001	<i>Psittacara erythrogenys</i>	RED-MASKED PARAKEET / RED-MASKED CONURE
000003	<i>Thectocercus acuticaudatus</i>	BLUE-CROWNED PARAKEET
000010	<i>Nymphicus hollandicus</i>	COCKATIEL
000006	<i>Pavo cristatus</i>	INDIAN PEAFOWL / COMMON PEAFOWL / PEAHEN / PEACOCK
000008	<i>Ara ararauna</i>	BLUE-AND-YELLOW MACAW / BLUE-AND-GOLD MACAW
000001	<i>Ara chloropterus</i>	RED-AND-GREEN MACAW / GREEN-WINGED MACAW
000003	<i>Ara macao</i>	SCARLET MACAW
000005	<i>Ara militaris</i>	MILITARY MACAW
000004	<i>Ara, Anodorhynchus, Primolius, Diopsittaca spp hybrid</i>	MACAW HYBRID
000001	<i>Cacatua moluccensis</i>	SALMON-CRESTED COCKATOO / MOLUCCAN COCKATOO
000001	<i>Cacatua alba</i>	WHITE COCKATOO / UMBRELLA COCKATOO
000003	<i>Cacatua galerita</i>	SULPHUR-CRESTED COCKATOO / GREATER SULPHUR-CRESTED COCKATOO
000007	<i>Sus scrofa domestica</i>	DOMESTIC PIG / POTBELLY PIG / MICRO PIG
000009	<i>Gallus gallus domesticus</i>	DOMESTIC CHICKEN (INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS / TURKIN / COCK / HEN / ROOSTER)
000001	<i>Panthera leo</i>	LION
000001	<i>Ursus arctos syriacus</i>	SYRIAN BROWN BEAR
000003	<i>Ursus americanus</i>	NORTH AMERICAN BLACK BEAR
000002	<i>Panthera tigris</i>	TIGER
000002	<i>Canis lupus</i>	GRAY WOLF / GREY WOLF / TIMBER WOLF
000001	<i>Dolichotis patagonum</i>	PATAGONIAN CAVY / MARA
000001	<i>Potos flavus</i>	KINKAJOU
000001	<i>Lynx rufus</i>	BOBCAT
000002	<i>Cebus capucinus</i>	WHITE-HEADED / WHITE-THROATED CAPUCHIN
000004	<i>Sapajus appella</i>	BROWN CAPUCHIN / TUFTED CAPUCHIN
000002	<i>Macaca mulatta</i>	RHESUS MACAQUE
000001	<i>Papio hamadryas</i>	HAMADRYAS BABOON
000002	<i>Canis mesomelas</i>	BLACK-BACKED JACKAL
000002	<i>Ateles geoffroyi</i>	BLACK-HANDED SPIDER MONKEY
000001	<i>Callithrix jacchus</i>	COMMON MARMOSET
000004	<i>Eulemur fulvus</i>	BROWN LEMUR
000001	<i>Hystrix cristata</i>	AFRICAN CRESTED PORCUPINE
000008	<i>Vulpes vulpes</i>	RED FOX (INCLUDES SILVER FOX & CROSS FOX)

000122 **Total**



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